

Job Seeker Interview Cheat Sheet

Prepare, answer clearly, and follow up.

USE IT IN 3 MOMENTS: before the interview, during practice, and after the interview.

Start with the required actions. Improve the optional details only after the basics are complete.

Interview details

Company	[Write here]	Role	[Write here]
Date	[DD Month YYYY]	Time zone	WIB / WITA / WIT
Interviewer	[Name and role]	Format	Online / In person
Link or place	[Write here]	Contact	[Recruiter contact]

15-minute minimum preparation

- [] Read the job post again. Mark the top three skills and responsibilities.
- [] Open the official company website and LinkedIn page. Note one product, customer, value, or recent activity you understand.
- [] Prepare a 60-second introduction and three STAR stories from class projects, internships, organizations, volunteering, or part-time work.
- [] Prepare two questions for the interviewer that are not already answered in the job post.
- [] Confirm the invitation, time zone, platform, and official contact. Never pay a recruitment fee.

Your answer rule

Answer first, then prove it

Give the main point in the first sentence. Add one relevant example. End by connecting it to the role. Most answers can be 60-90 seconds; follow the interviewer's cues.

1. Build your introduction

Use Present - Past - Future. Keep personal details job-relevant.

Part	What to say	Your notes
Present	Your degree or current focus and target role.	[Write 1 sentence]
Past	One or two relevant experiences, skills, or results.	[Write 2-3 sentences]
Future	Why this role and what you can contribute or learn.	[Write 1 sentence]

Fictional example

Example

I recently completed a Communication degree, and I am focusing on entry-level digital marketing roles. During a four-month internship, I prepared weekly social media reports and worked with the content team on 24 posts. A campus research project also taught me how to turn survey data into practical recommendations. I am interested in this role because it combines analysis and communication, and I would like to contribute while learning from an experienced marketing team.

Your version:

Do not include

- A full life story, unrelated family details, or private information.
- Claims you cannot support with an example.
- A memorized speech delivered too quickly. Practice the structure, not every word.

2. Build a STAR story bank

One story can answer several behavior questions.

STAR = Situation, Task, Action, Result. Spend most of your answer on your action. If the result was not perfect, explain what you learned and changed.

Story	Situation	Task	Action	Result or learning
Achievement A project, event, internship task, grade, competition, or process you improved.	Context: []	Goal: []	What I did: []	Evidence: []
Teamwork or conflict A time you listened, clarified roles, solved a disagreement, or helped the team move forward.	Context: []	Goal: []	What I did: []	Evidence: []
Initiative A time you noticed a need and acted without waiting for detailed instructions.	Context: []	Goal: []	What I did: []	Evidence: []
Setback or mistake A real mistake with limited risk, followed by ownership, correction, and learning.	Context: []	Goal: []	What I did: []	Evidence: []
Deadline or change A time priority changed, time was limited, or you had to learn quickly.	Context: []	Goal: []	What I did: []	Evidence: []

Relevant experience counts

You may use internships, class projects, theses, student organizations, competitions, volunteering, freelance work, family business support, or part-time work. State the context clearly and do not describe a class task as paid employment.

Worked STAR example

Question: Tell me about a time you had to improve a result before a deadline.

STAR	Example answer
Situation	A career webinar had 82 registrations one week before a target of 150.
Task	As the communications coordinator, I needed to increase relevant registrations before the deadline.
Action	I reviewed channel performance, rewrote the message for two audience groups, and scheduled three posts plus reminders through partner communities.
Result	Registrations reached 156 by the deadline and 132 people attended. The team reused the checklist for the next event.

Why it works: the action is specific, the result is measurable, and the answer stays focused on the candidate's contribution.

3. Prepare common questions

Know the purpose, then use your own evidence.

Question	What they may assess	Answer plan
Tell me about yourself.	Check fit and communication.	Use Present - Past - Future. End with why this role fits.
Why this company and role?	Check research and motivation.	Mention one specific company or role fact, why it matters to you, and how your evidence fits.
What are your strengths?	Check self-awareness and relevance.	Choose one or two strengths from the job post. Give a short example for each.
What is one weakness?	Check honesty and learning behavior.	Choose a real, non-critical gap. Explain what you are doing, how you track progress, and what has improved.
Why should we hire you?	Check your value for the role.	Combine role fit, one proof point, and your learning readiness. Avoid claiming you are better than other candidates.
Tell me about a challenge or conflict.	Check behavior under pressure.	Use STAR. Show listening, your action, and the outcome. Do not blame other people.
Tell me about a mistake or failure.	Check ownership.	Choose a real example. State the correction and the system or habit you changed.
What are your career plans?	Check direction and realistic expectations.	Describe skills and responsibilities you want to build. Keep the answer connected to the role.

Question	What they may assess	Answer plan
What are your salary expectations?	Check alignment with the hiring budget.	Research comparable entry-level roles and local minimum wage rules. Clarify whether figures are gross monthly pay and consider benefits. Give a researched range or ask for the approved range; stay honest and flexible.
When can you start?	Check availability.	Give a clear date and mention any graduation, notice, or document commitment that affects it.

Safe salary example

Example wording

Based on the role scope and the market information I have reviewed for entry-level positions in this location, I am looking for a fair package within the company's approved range. Could you share the budgeted range and benefits for this role? I am open to discussing the full package and learning opportunities.

4. Ask useful questions

An interview is also your chance to understand the role.

Choose two or three

- ☐ What would a good first three months look like in this role?
- ☐ What tasks would take most of my time in a normal week?
- ☐ **How does the team support onboarding, feedback, and learning for someone new to the role?**
- ☐ What skills separate someone good in this role from someone excellent?
- ☐ What is the biggest challenge the team wants this person to help solve?
- ☐ What are the next steps and expected timeline in the recruitment process?

Ask HR about process, policy, benefits, and contract. Ask the hiring manager or user interviewer about the work, team, success measures, and learning. Do not ask a question already answered clearly in the job post or company website.

Online interview checklist

- ☐ Test the link, camera, microphone, charging cable, and internet connection.
- ☐ Use a quiet, well-lit space and a simple background. Silence notifications.
- ☐ Display a professional account name and join 5-10 minutes early.
- ☐ Keep your CV, the job post, water, and short notes nearby. Do not read full scripts.

In-person interview checklist

- ☐ Plan the route and travel buffer. Aim to arrive 10-15 minutes early, not much earlier.
- ☐ Wear clean, professional clothing suitable for the company and role.
- ☐ Bring the requested documents in a neat folder. Do not hand over original identity documents unless a verified process requires inspection.
- ☐ Treat reception, security, and every employee politely.

Recruitment safety in Indonesia

Stop and verify

Check the vacancy through the company's official website, official social media, or a trusted job platform. Be cautious with personal email domains, unclear job details, instant chat-only interviews, or requests for transfer, administration, training, travel, accommodation, or uniform fees. Never share a password or OTP.

Standard grooming for interviews

Choose a neat, comfortable level of formality that fits the company, role, and interview invitation. When unsure, ask the recruiter or dress slightly more formally than the role's daily wear.



Illustrative examples: business casual to formal. Religious and cultural clothing can be professional and appropriate.

- Wear clean, pressed clothing that fits comfortably and allows natural movement.
- Keep hair, face, nails, shoes, and accessories neat; use fragrance lightly or not at all.
- Avoid distracting slogans, damaged clothing, or anything that makes you uncomfortable during the interview.
- Match the employer's verified instructions. Different sectors and roles may expect different levels of formality.

5. Close and learn

Finish professionally, then improve while the interview is fresh.

Closing sentence

Example

Thank you for your time and for explaining the role. I am interested in the opportunity because [one specific reason]. Is there any part of my experience you would like me to clarify before we finish?

Follow-up message

Send within 24 hours when you have the interviewer's or recruiter's contact

Subject: Thank you - [Your Name], [Role]

Dear [Name],

Thank you for speaking with me today about the [Role] position. I appreciated learning about [specific topic]. The discussion strengthened my interest in contributing through [relevant skill or experience]. Please let me know if you need any additional information.

Kind regards,
[Your Name]

Practice feedback

Check	Yes / Not yet	One improvement
Answer was clear and relevant	☐ Yes ☐ Not yet	[Write one action]
Used specific evidence	☐ Yes ☐ Not yet	[Write one action]
Stayed truthful	☐ Yes ☐ Not yet	[Write one action]
Sounded natural, not memorized	☐ Yes ☐ Not yet	[Write one action]
Asked useful questions	☐ Yes ☐ Not yet	[Write one action]

Sources and limits

[Jobstreet Indonesia: common interview questions and STAR guidance \(updated 5 June 2026\)](#)

[Jobstreet Indonesia: questions candidates can ask \(updated 22 January 2025\)](#)

[Kemnaker: prevent fake job vacancy scams \(2024\)](#)

[Stephen P. Anderson, Seductive Interaction Design \(2011\)](#)

Limit: Interview style, dress expectations, selection steps, salary, and documents differ by company, sector, location, and role. Follow the verified employer's instructions. Salary guidance here is a preparation method, not a market quote or legal opinion.